

- Proxy service, wherein the firewall makes the Internet requests rather than the computer itself. The data that the firewall retrieves is then sent to your computer.
- Stateful inspection, wherein only certain parts of packets are analysed by the firewall. This is done by comparing these parts to a database of trusted packets.

But why do you need a firewall when you already have an anti-virus? Well, there are some functionalities that only a firewall can provide. For example, a firewall protects your computer from the threat of remote logins. Effective firewalls can block access to files and applications on your computer that others may be trying to access. Firewalls also protect against application backdoors: some applications have features that allow remote access, and these act as backdoors to your computer that hackers try and exploit.

8.2.2 Which Firewall?

XP comes with an inbuilt personal firewall. The firewall is enabled by default. It can be accessed through the Security Center in the Control Panel. It is advisable to turn it on and leave it on while you are connected to a network.

There are also several third-party



Leave Windows Firewall on when you're online